

UPSC INDIAN POLITY

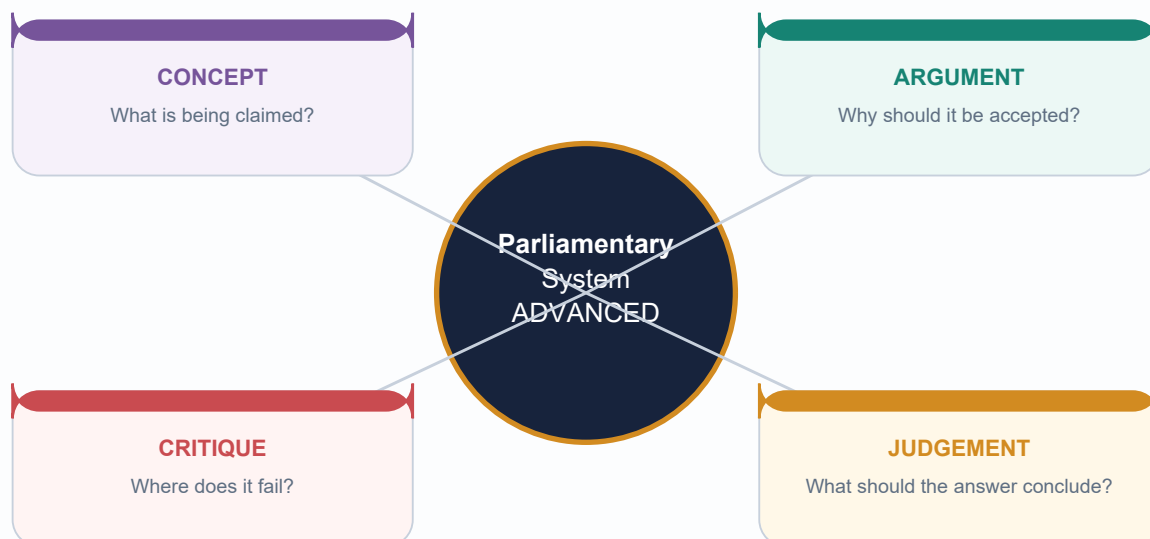
Parliamentary System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: Parliamentary-System.md + 11_Parliamentary-System.md

Learning cards: 20



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation • Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity • **Tier:** Basic (foundation) • **GS Paper:** GS-II*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

Dimension 1

greater than **Subject:** Polity • **Tier:** Basic (foundation) • **GS Paper:** GS-II

Dimension 2

greater than **Grounded in:** Laxmikant Ch. 12. □ = from book • □□ = inference • □ = current affairs.

Dimension 3

greater than **Full depth:**
advanced/11Parliamentary-System.md.

STATIC THEORY

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MUST-KNOW FACTS

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MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED /
COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation • Snapshot

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
□ Articles	Centre: 74 & 75 ; States: 163 & 164
□ Also called	Cabinet / Responsible / Westminster government
□ Core test	Executive is responsible to the legislature
□ Model borrowed from	Britain (but not a replica)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED /
COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Executive (real = **PM + Council of Ministers**) is **drawn from and answerable to** the legislature, and stays only while it holds the **Lok Sabha's confidence**. President = **nominal** head; PM = **real** head. Art 74 advice is **binding** on the President.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

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MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · The 8 features

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than □ **Mnemonic: "N-M-C-P-D-L-D-S" = Nominal/real executives · Majority-party rule ·**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

THE 8 FEATURES: RECALL MAP

The 8 features

Dimension 1

greater than □ Mnemonic: "N-M-C-P-D-L-D-S" = Nominal/real executives · Majority-party rule ·

Dimension 2

greater than Collective responsibility · Political homogeneity · Double membership · Leadership of PM ·

Dimension 3

greater than Dissolution of Lok Sabha · Secrecy.

Dimension 4

□ Collective responsibility (Art 75) is the **bedrock** — the whole ministry falls on a no-confidence motion in the Lok Sabha ("swim and sink together"). □ **Double membership**: a minister not an MP for **6 months** ceases to hold office.

STATIC THEORY

• greater than **Collective responsibility** · **Political homogeneity** · **Double membership** · **Leadership of PM** ·

• greater than **Dissolution of Lok Sabha** · **Secrecy**.

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MEMORY HOOK

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MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Collective responsibility (Art 75)** is the **bedrock** — the whole ministry falls on a **no-confidence motion** in the Lok Sabha ("swim and sink together"). **Double membership**: a minister not an MP for **6 months** ceases to hold office.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Parliamentary System — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → The 8 features

HIGH**Foundation · Parliamentary vs Presidential**

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

	Parliamentary	Presidential (USA)
□ Executive	Dual (nominal+real)	Single
□ Term	Not fixed	Fixed
□ Powers	Fusion	Separation
□ Dissolve lower house	Yes	No

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Parliamentary System — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Parliamentary vs Presidential

HIGH**Foundation · Why India chose it**

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Ambedkar**: preferred **more responsibility** over more stability. Plus **familiarity** (K.M. Munshi), avoiding legislature-executive conflict, and **wide representation** for a plural society. □ **Swaran Singh Committee (1975)** → keep the parliamentary system.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Ambedkar**: preferred **more responsibility** over more stability. Plus **familiarity** (K.M. Munshi), avoiding legislature-executive conflict, and **wide representation** for a plural society. **Swaran Singh Committee (1975)** → keep the parliamentary system.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Parliamentary System — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Why India chose it

HIGH

Foundation • Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ India = **republican** (elected President); Britain = **monarchical** (hereditary).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

Dimension 1 □ India = republican (elected President); Britain = monarchical (hereditary).	Dimension 2 □ Britain has parliamentary sovereignty; India's Parliament is NOT supreme.
Dimension 3 □ UK PM must be from Commons; Indian PM may be from either House.	Dimension 4 □ Jennings: "leader of the opposition is the alternative PM." Bagehot: cabinet is a "hyphen".

STATIC THEORY

- □ Britain has **parliamentary sovereignty**; India's Parliament is **NOT** supreme.
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- □ Jennings: "leader of the opposition is the **alternative PM**." Bagehot: cabinet is a "**hyphen**".

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. India = **republican** (elected President); Britain = **monarchical** (hereditary).
2. Britain has **parliamentary sovereignty**; India's Parliament is **NOT** supreme.
3. UK PM must be from **Commons**; Indian PM may be from **either House**.
4. Jennings: "leader of the opposition is the **alternative PM**." Bagehot: cabinet is a "**hyphen**".

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation • □ Current link

GS-II Indian
Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □ □ Coalition instability & "one-nation-one-election" debates periodically revive the **presidential-vs-parliamentary** question; anti-defection floor-tests keep collective responsibility topical. □ □ For all 8 features, merits/demerits, USA contrast & Indian-vs-British model → advanced/11_Parliamentary-System.md.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED /
COMPLETE → [Current link](#)

HIGH

Advanced • Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

Dimension 1

greater than Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) ·
GS Paper: GS-II

Dimension 2

greater than Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 12 / "Parliamentary System" (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).

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greater than Companion: basic/Parliamentary-System.md.

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MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED /
COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced • What it is

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ India adopts a **parliamentary form** at both Centre (**Art 74 & 75**) and states (**Art 163 & 164**). Classification is by **executive–legislature relations**: in a **parliamentary** system the executive is **responsible to the legislature**; in a **presidential** system the executive is **not responsible** and has a **fixed** term, constitutionally independent.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- Also called **cabinet government / responsible government / Westminster model** (Britain, Japan, Canada, India). Presidential = **non-responsible / fixed-executive** (USA, Brazil, Russia, Sri Lanka). □ **Ivor Jennings** → "cabinet system" (cabinet = nucleus of power). □ PM once "**primus inter pares**" (first among equals); now analysts (**Crossman, Mackintosh**) call it "**prime ministerial government**" — true in India too.

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MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What it is

HIGH

Advanced · Features of the parliamentary system (8)



GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

#	Feature	Detail
□ 1	Nominal & real executives	President = nominal/de jure/titular ; PM = real/de facto . Art 74 CoM aids & advises President — advice is binding .
□ 2	Majority party rule	Majority party in Lok Sabha forms govt; leader = PM. Coalition if no single majority.
□ 3	Collective responsibility □	Bedrock principle (Art 75). CoM collectively responsible to Lok Sabha — a no-confidence motion removes the whole ministry.
□ 4	Political homogeneity	Ministers usually same party/ideology (coalition → bound by consensus).
□ 5	Double membership	Minister must be an MP; if not an MP for 6 consecutive months , ceases to be minister.
□ 6	Leadership of the PM	PM = leader of CoM, of Parliament, and of the ruling party.
□ 7	Dissolution of Lower House	President can dissolve Lok Sabha on PM's advice → fresh elections.
□ 8	Secrecy	Ministers take oath of secrecy (administered by President).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Features of the parliamentary system (8) □

HIGH

Advanced · Presidential system (USA) — contrast □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

	Parliamentary	Presidential
□ Executive	Dual (nominal + real)	Single
□ Term	Not fixed (removable)	Fixed
□ Responsibility	Responsible	Non-responsible
□ Membership	Double	Single
□ Dissolution of lower house	Yes	No
□ Powers	Fusion of powers	Separation of powers

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Presidential system (USA) — contrast □

HIGH

Advanced · Presidential system (USA) — contrast □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ (a) President = head of State **and** government; (b) elected by **electoral college** for **fixed 4-year** term, removable only by **impeachment**; (c) governs via non-elected secretaries ("**Kitchen Cabinet**"), responsible only to him; (d) executive **not** responsible to Congress, not members of it; (e) **cannot dissolve** House of Representatives; (f) based on **separation of powers**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

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MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Presidential system (USA) — contrast □

HIGH

Advanced · Merits & demerits □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Merits:** (1) harmony between legislature & executive; (2) **responsible government** (question hour, adjournment/no-confidence motions); (3) prevents despotism (authority in a group); (4) **ready alternative government** — Jennings: "leader of opposition is the alternative PM"; (5) wide representation. □ **Demerits:** (1) **unstable government** (Morarji Desai, Charan Singh, V.P. Singh, Chandra Shekhar, Deve Gowda, I.K. Gujral); (2) no continuity of policies; (3) **dictatorship of the cabinet** (Laski; Ramsay Muir — "dictatorship of the cabinet"; Indira/Rajiv era); (4) against separation of powers (**Bagehot**: "cabinet is a hyphen that joins...the executive and legislative"); (5) government by amateurs.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

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MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Parliamentary System — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Merits & demerits □

HIGH**Advanced · Why India adopted it □**GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

□ (1) **Familiarity** with the system from British rule (**K.M. Munshi:** "why...buy a novel experience"); (2) **Ambedkar** — preferred **more responsibility to more stability** (US = more stability/less responsibility; British = more responsibility/less stability); (3) **avoid legislature–executive conflict** in an infant democracy; (4) **heterogeneous society** needs wide representation. □ **Swaran Singh Committee (1975)** examined presidential-vs-parliamentary → keep parliamentary.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

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MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Parliamentary System — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Why India adopted it □

HIGH**Advanced · Indian vs British model — 3 differences □**GS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

□ (1) India = **republican** (elected President) vs Britain = **monarchical** (hereditary King/Queen); (2) Britain = **parliamentary sovereignty**; India = **Parliament NOT supreme** (written Constitution, federalism, judicial review, FRs); (3) UK PM must be from **House of Commons**; Indian PM may be from **either House**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

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MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Indian vs British model — 3 differences □

HIGH**Advanced · UPSC Traps****GS-II** Indian Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: CoM collectively responsible to Rajya Sabha

CORRECT: to the **Lok Sabha** (Art 75).

WRONG: A non-MP can never be a minister

CORRECT: allowed, but must become an MP within **6 months**.

WRONG: Parliamentary system = separation of powers

CORRECT: it is **fusion** of powers.

WRONG: Indian PM must be from Lok Sabha

CORRECT: may be from **either House** (unlike UK's Commons rule).

WRONG: President's advice from CoM is optional

CORRECT: **binding** (42nd/44th Amendments to Art 74).

WRONG: Swaran Singh Committee recommended presidential system

CORRECT: it recommended **keeping parliamentary**.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced • CA hooks

GS-II Indian
Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □ □ Recurring debate on shifting to a **presidential system** / "one-nation-one-election" resurfaces around coalition instability — but Swaran Singh line still holds. □ □ Frequent floor-tests & anti-defection cases keep **collective responsibility & no-confidence** live.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ CA hooks.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED /
COMPLETE → □ CA hooks

HIGH

Advanced • Mains angles

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Is the parliamentary system responsible for governance instability in India, or has coalition-era maturity disproved it? "Prime ministerial government" — has the PM's dominance weakened cabinet collective responsibility? Presidential vs parliamentary: what suits India's plural society better?

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED /
COMPLETE → Mains angles

HIGH

Advanced • Verified PYQ application

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Verified PYQ application.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

□ **2024 GS-II Q3 (10 marks, 150 words):** "The growth of cabinet system has practically resulted in the marginalisation of the parliamentary supremacy. Elucidate." Route: fusion of powers + party majority/whip + delegated legislation and agenda control -greater than weakened scrutiny; qualify with questions, committees, no-confidence and judicially enforceable constitutional limits. Cross-link 16_PM-and-Council-of-Ministers.md for cabinet/PM concentration and 17_Parliament.md for scrutiny correctives.

STUDY LINK

Parliamentary System — ADVANCED /
COMPLETE → Verified PYQ application

End of Register Notes — UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI